

TEACHING EVALUATION SUMMARY

Zihang Li

Auburn University • zzl0134@auburn.edu • zihangli.com

I have taught Principles of Microeconomics and Macroeconomics as an independent instructor at Auburn University, with full course responsibility, and led Econometrics recitations as a teaching assistant. This summary presents end-of-term evaluations across seven course offerings, together with student comments and examples of how I use feedback to improve instruction.

End-of-term evaluation overview

Term	Course / role	Overall	Enrolled	Respondents	Response
Fall 2023	Microeconomics / instructor	4.37	33	32	96.97%
Spring 2024	Macroeconomics / instructor	5.21	42	37	88.10%
Fall 2024	Econometrics / TA	5.39	17	12	70.59%
Spring 2025	Microeconomics / instructor	5.33	25	20	80.00%
Fall 2025	Econometrics / TA	5.86	6	4	66.67%
Spring 2026	Macroeconomics / instructor	5.03	41	19	46.34%
Summer 2026	Microeconomics / instructor	5.30	20	16	80.00%

Scale: 1 = strongly disagree; 6 = strongly agree. Overall values are the source summary's averages of seven core items. Respondents are computed from enrollment and response rate. Instructor and TA ratings reflect different responsibilities and class sizes.

Ratings by core item

Core item	F23	S24	F24	S25	F25	S26	Su26
Student-instructor interaction	4.80	5.10	5.80	5.70	6.00	4.90	5.30
Peer collaboration	4.00	5.20	5.50	4.60	5.50	5.00	4.70
High academic expectations	4.30	5.20	5.50	5.10	6.00	5.10	5.40
Regular progress feedback	4.20	5.00	5.30	5.30	5.50	5.10	5.50
Application of concepts	4.40	5.30	5.40	5.50	6.00	5.20	5.30
Critical thinking	4.70	5.50	5.00	5.60	6.00	5.10	5.60
Support for success	4.20	5.20	5.20	5.50	6.00	4.80	5.30

F = fall; S = spring; Su = summer. F24 and F25 are Econometrics TA evaluations; all other columns are principles-course instructor evaluations. Item labels are abbreviated for space.

Reading the results in context

My principles ratings rose after my first independent course and have stayed between 5.03 and 5.33 since. Fall 2023 was my first time teaching a full course independently; its overall rating was 4.37. I prepared extensively, but I learned during that semester that every class date and each class's materials need to be set in advance, so I adjusted the pace while teaching. By my second course in Spring 2024, I knew what the course required, was more familiar with Auburn's course systems, and had students' feedback to build on; my later principles courses were rated 5.21 (Spring 2024), 5.33 (Spring 2025), 5.03 (Spring 2026), and 5.30 (Summer 2026). The Econometrics TA ratings were 5.39 in Fall 2024 and 5.86 in Fall 2025; the latter rests on 4 respondents in a six-student course.

Sources: official Auburn eValue reports, Fall 2023–Summer 2026. Comments are selected excerpts; an ellipsis marks omitted text. Midsemester results: ECON 2030 survey exports, April 1 and 3, 2026, Q25 (satisfaction with changes after Midterm 1); 17/18 = 94.4%.

Student comments on principles instruction

"I thought it was clever to use the news to apply our fairly basic principles to real world scenarios... I really liked the lecture where we changed teaching styles and used the game website and talked as a group."

Principles of Microeconomics, Spring 2025

"I liked how he always posted the class notes after class and how he went over the test questions after each exam... He was also very encouraging to ask questions."

Principles of Microeconomics, Spring 2025

"Professor Li is a really good teacher; his class is very structured, and he has helped me multiple times by going over previous tests and assignments, and by going over what I missed."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2026

"I appreciated the bonus problems and assignments, very helpful for exam prep."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2026

"I also felt that he paced the semester well and was agile in adjusting to meet our specific class' needs."

Principles of Macroeconomics, Spring 2024

"I did enjoy the slide handouts and walk-through lectures."

Principles of Microeconomics, Summer 2026

Student comments on empirical training and support

"Zihang was a great TA. He taught us how to code in R every Monday and provided every material we needed to succeed in the course."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"Incredibly knowledgeable and easy to talk to... knew how to answer students' questions, even when the student had no idea what they were asking, providing feedback that removed prior doubts."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"He was very flexible with his office hours and was very informative on research methods within the class and topics that we were researching."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2024

"He always answered questions, supported his students, and helped us to think critically about the material and our project."

Econometrics TA, Fall 2025

Turning feedback into course changes

In Spring 2026, I used repeated midsemester surveys to ask students about pacing, practice, and exam preparation. When students requested more practice problems, I reduced lecture time and expanded guided problem solving. In surveys collected after Midterm 2, **17 of 18 responses (94%)** were satisfied or very satisfied with the changes made after Midterm 1. These are response records across two survey rounds, not a verified count of distinct students or a measure of learning gains. One student wrote in the April 1 survey: *"Gives plenty of practice problems and examples. I enjoy when you incorporate real news/events."*

I also build tools and activities that give students more ways to practice and participate. In class I use my own free web games, *Oligopoly* in microeconomics and the *Tulip Bulb Investment Game* in macroeconomics, along with polls and Padlet; I built *Welfare Lab* in Summer 2026 for my next course. My completion of Auburn's Biggio Center Course (Re)Design Program in Summer 2024 and Summer 2026 helped me align these activities with learning objectives and assessments.